

Left and Right with Oliver

Kick off with a football game that teaches left and right.



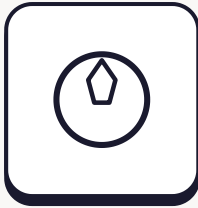
Ages 4 to 7

Print and play

Cut, sort and trace

Oliver kicks with his right foot. Learn which is left and which is right,
then sort, trace and follow the arrows to the goal.

How to play, and the grown up guide



Right, team, let us kick off. I kick a football with my **RIGHT** foot, so my right side is easy to remember. First we find left and right on your body, then on the page. Once you know which is which, you are ready for the whole match. Come on, boots on.

START WITH THE BODY

Stand up together first. Wave your right hand, then your left. Hop on your right foot, then your left. Point right, then left. Do this before any page so left and right live in the body, not just on paper.

THEN MOVE TO THE PAGE

On every page, left is the side of your left hand and right is the side of your right hand. Rest both hands flat on the table with the page in the middle. Now the page and the body agree, and the sorting makes sense.

OLIVER'S TRICK FOR REMEMBERING

The kicking foot. Ask your child which foot they would kick a ball with. For most children that is the right foot. Tap that foot and say right, tap the other and say left. Come back to the kicking foot whenever they are unsure. A body memory beats a rule every time.

ANSWER NOTE • GROWN UPS ONLY

Sorting mat cards. LEFT side: left arrow, hand pointing left, car facing left, left football boot, footballer kicking left, signpost pointing left.

RIGHT side: right arrow, hand pointing right, car facing right, right football boot, footballer kicking right, signpost pointing right.

Every card shows a small arrow in the top corner pointing to its correct side, so a stuck child can self check. **Six cards belong on the left and six on the right.**

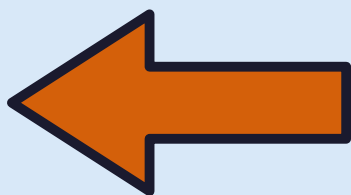
WHAT IS INSIDE

One big left and right sorting mat, twelve cards to cut out and sort, a which hand tracing and pointing page, and a follow the arrows path to the goal. Print the whole set, or just the page you need today. Laminate the mat and reuse it again and again.

The left and right sorting mat

This is your pitch. Cut out the cards from the next two pages, then place each one on the correct side. Left cards on the LEFT, right cards on the RIGHT. Say the word out loud as you place each one.

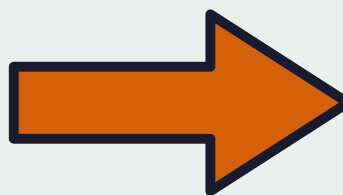
LEFT



Place the LEFT cards here

This is the side of your left hand

RIGHT



Place the RIGHT cards here

This is the side of your right hand

Left hand goes here

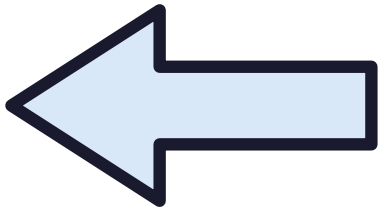
REST A HAND ON EACH SIDE

Right hand goes here

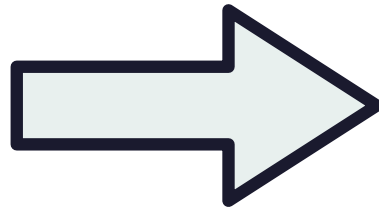
Goal for a winner: every card on the correct side, with no peeking at the corner arrow until you have had a good try.

Cards to cut out and sort

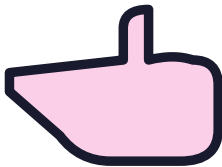
Cut along the dashed lines with a grown up. Look at each card, decide left or right, then place it on the matching side of the pitch. The little arrow in the corner shows the correct side if you get stuck.



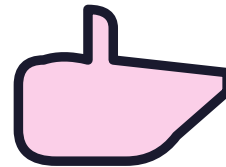
This arrow points left



This arrow points right



Hand pointing left



Hand pointing right



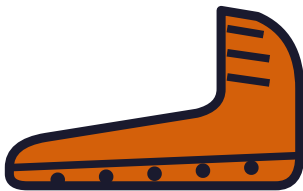
Car facing left



Car facing right

More cards to cut and sort

Here are the football cards. Boots, kicks and signposts, each one pointing left or right. Cut them out, sort them onto the pitch, and shout left or right like a real match commentator.



Left football boot



Right football boot



Kicking to the left



Kicking to the right



Signpost pointing left



Signpost pointing right

Trace your hands, then play

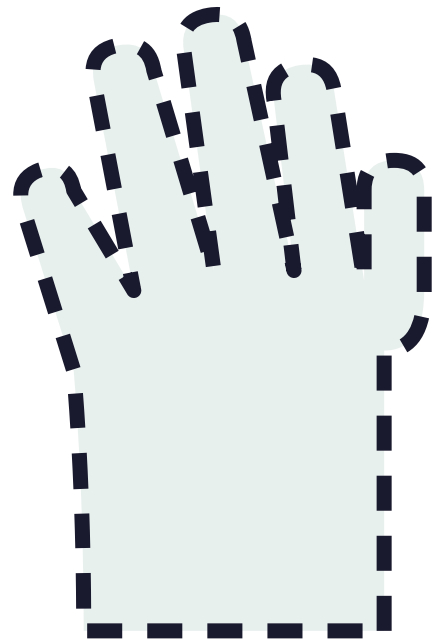
Put your LEFT hand flat on the left box and draw round it. Then your RIGHT hand on the right box. Now you have your very own left and right hands on the page. Colour them in if you like.

TRACE YOUR LEFT HAND



LEFT

TRACE YOUR RIGHT HAND



RIGHT

PUT YOUR RIGHT HAND ON...

A grown up reads each one. Do the action, then tick the box when you get it right. Take it slowly, this is a warm up not a race.

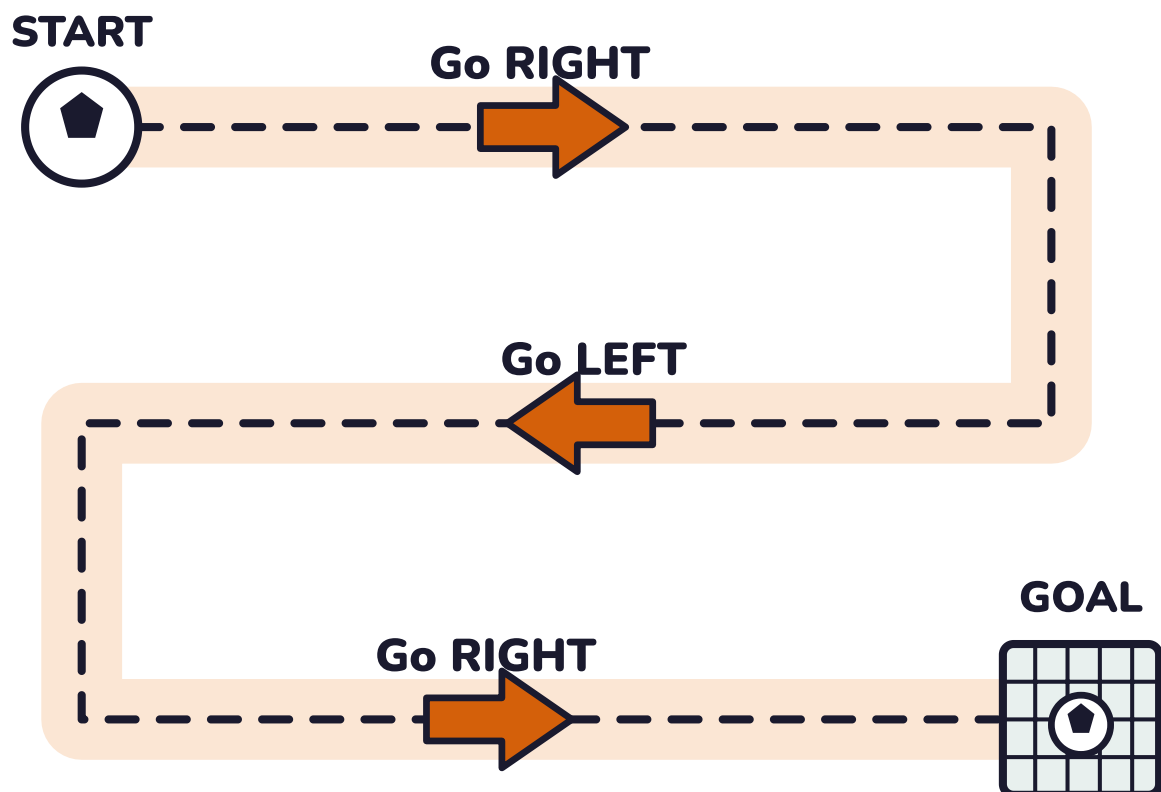
- ☐ Right hand on your head
- ☐ Right hand on your left knee
- ☐ Right foot forward, like a kick

- ☐ Left hand on your tummy
- ☐ Left hand on your right ear
- ☐ Wave your left hand high

Follow the arrows to the goal

Time to dribble to the goal. Start at the ball. Follow each arrow and say left or right out loud as you turn. Trace the path with your finger first, then with a pen. Score the winning goal at the end.

START AT THE BALL • FINISH AT THE GOAL



Say each arrow out loud as you trace: right, then left, then right into the goal.

Play again: this time you be the coach and call the turns while a grown up traces. Swap over and see who can call left and right the fastest.